MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, with recent work focused on CI/CD pipelines, ephemeral environments and build tooling. Own GitLab CI pipelines supporting three product teams and approximately 25 developers. Bring measurable improvements in delivery speed, infrastructure cost and test reliability, complemented by personal projects in Terraform, GitOps and observability. Seeking a transition into DevOps / platform engineering.

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | 2021 - Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams, covering builds, unit, integration and end-to-end tests, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes through parallel test jobs, dependency caching and separate end-to-end stages; reduced monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.
- Built per-merge-request ephemeral environments, initially with Docker Compose and later with Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, with automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Work at namespace level on Kubernetes; the platform team operates the cluster.
- Maintain approximately 900 pytest and Playwright tests. Built a Python, PostgreSQL and Grafana dashboard to identify flaky tests, helping teams reduce the flaky rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Write Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test data seeding.
- Authored the internal CI guide used in onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019 - 2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins jobs for nightly execution.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018 - 2019

- Investigated customer issues through logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

PERSONAL INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | 2024 - 2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from Git through Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS certificate management.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a personal Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used basic Ansible.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm.
Infrastructure as code and GitOps: Terraform (personal projects), Argo CD; basic Ansible.
Kubernetes: Helm-based test deployments with namespace-level access; personal k3s cluster.
Observability: Grafana dashboards for test metrics; Prometheus and Loki in homelab.
Programming and systems: Python, Bash, SQL, Java (test code), Linux, Git, PostgreSQL.
Cloud: AWS EC2 and S3 basics through personal learning; personal Hetzner VPS.
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027, not yet certified.

LANGUAGES

Polish: native | English: C1 | German: A2